

Pandora's box

We write 2050. Of course, we could write a much shorter number here, today's world is so different from that of those who have accounted for it so far. At the same time, our world is not a denial, but a continuation of everything that our predecessors dreamed, invented and created. If we were to throw away the lessons, however bitter, that also determine our lives, we would still make everything worse, and we would still not be able to look our descendants in the eye, as they look away when we ask them about their own time. Yet they have no more reason to be ashamed than their predecessors, us, or even our descendants. We are all human, with similar urges, dreams, and failures... but they were given the opportunity to be human in a very special era.

When they were children, the horror of the last war, fought with nuclear weapons, threatened them. Back then, the logical conclusion was: "East" against "West", a community organized from above against a community built from below, communism against the capitalist system.

But they decided to remain children: they would not become servants of any idea, to join the armies that were fighting each other without question just to feel like adults. If man is an inescapable self-destructive being, then it is better to remain small, to enjoy the opportunities that his predecessors created. To have fun, to consume, to want bigger, more beautiful, better in everything than others, not to think about consequences, resources, or those who might be left out of all this. Just to play, to cheer enthusiastically, to chase the dream of eternal youth, immortality, happiness everywhere, in everything.

Unfortunately, they were terrifyingly strong "children". First, while carefreely chasing their dreams, and later, running away from the nightmare created by the ruthless logic of the fairy tales that created an excuse for this, in a single generation they used up a significant part of our resources, destroyed the cycles of our planet's biodiversity, and scattered radioactive waste everywhere with a time span of hundreds of thousands of years. Our lives, and those of the future after us, are greatly limited by this legacy.

Yet we owe them thanks. Thanks for the fact that we exist at all, and that we have the chance to make decisions and create, precisely because they threw away the concept of adulthood they knew, choosing a simple, childlike life instead of a heroic death. Thanks for choosing life again at the last moment, the painful process of awakening to self-awareness. Thanks for the honesty with which they finally faced themselves and us, threw away their castles in the air, and created the basic concepts on which the flexible, constantly changing, yet solid framework of our lives today is built.

How did the change begin? As in all great works of music. At the climax of the piece, every instrument plays at full power, a war cry, a children's song, a religious song, a circus twang merge into one gigantic chaos. The sound of the orchestra vibrates the building, it hurts the ears of the musicians and listeners, dissonant, frightening runs burst out of it, as if everyone had lost the thread and control over the melodies. Then an instrument appears, as if it had found a single, simple melody that had been hiding in the background of the piece all along; it begins to play quietly but persistently.

At first, it is not even noticeable, nor is it known exactly when it began, as it is only noticed when more and more instruments start to turn down the volume and play their own parts that run parallel to the first melody, harmonizing with it. Eventually, the chaos dies down, only its memory continues to vibrate in the room, while the music transforms into a constantly changing harmony emerging among countless individual melodies that blend together, chase, and flow.

It kind of happened like this. In the 2010s, in the then dominant “developed states”, all the whistles, drums and trumpets roared at the same time. Melody and harmony: the meaning, knowledge carried by words, and their interaction no longer mattered, only the volume, the colors, the smile intended to be convincing, both determined and understanding on the surface of selfishness and will that was clearly snarling to everyone. Due to the clear power relations, social media turned from informing the “masses” to influencing them, and art, instead of awakening thoughts, switched to entertaining and instilling meaningless patterns, because that was “sellable”.

The targeted “mass” fled to the newly emerging direct communication tools and networks, but even here they were unable to do anything but mindlessly repeat and spread the patterns they had received earlier. They screamed at each other with their ears closed due to the external noise, not understanding anything from those with whom they communicated in person, since they were not used to looking for meaning in others rather than excuses. Those who were not yet terrified by the worthless garbage flowing from the media were numbed by the doomsday prophecies, conspiracy theories and monstrous racial theories preached with complete conviction by the “alternative thinkers” into chattering and laughing wrecks on the surface, but desperate and helpless inside. Of course, there were those who built communities out of defiance “just because” they offered a temporary illusion of survival and sustainability on the periphery of a world rushing towards destruction for those who desired it, something in which, if not well-founded trust, one could at least hope.

It would be difficult to determine where and when the pattern of thought that is considered sensible even to today's eyes first appeared, since it was present in writings dating back thousands of years. In vain, since it was only painted on battle flags by those who were unable to grasp their meaning, in an age that, due to the lack of communication tools, common language and basic knowledge, was not yet capable of operating today's system. With the development of all technical and civilizational conditions, they were first used incorrectly. Now too, we had to rush to the edge of the abyss, we had to feel the cold breath of death on our faces in order to turn towards our fears and pains that had been swept under the rug and not processed until then.

In the immense noise, we discovered that we only heard our own fearful screams echoing from billions of throats. More and more of us took our hands off our ears, let the worthless noise rush over us, and began to search for meaning. We became quiet, spoke softly, turned to each other with trust, and received trust back. Of course, this had always existed, and then it would have been insufficient on its own. However, networks emerged that made it possible to establish connections, to share and organize real values, knowledge, and resources for anyone, for any purpose that was accepted and found useful by the given community.

Of course, there were stumbles on both an individual and community level, but “karma” (which in this environment simply means that everyone's every decision, opinion, and word they utter is followed by the rest of their lives) quickly cut off the wild shoots. It was no longer possible to make the community forget the words they had previously said and then denied with “marketing tools.” The castles in the air of politics and economics, which were considered monopolistic at the time and had long since died, collapsed with one simple question: “Exactly what skills does it take to be an outstanding businessman or politician today?”

It was no longer possible to secretly acquire goods for ourselves, because the system took every angle into account. “Slavery!” many shouted at the time – but this approach is simply about the fact that the childish psyche is truly transformed into a responsible, community- and generation-thinking, adult human consciousness only under the influence of coercion. And this coercion is the system's ability to confront everyone with themselves and their actions, and to share them with others according to the degree of their relationship.

The closer I get to another person, the more serious responsibility I want to take on in a community, the more they see of me, and not just the part of me that I want to show. That way they can make responsible decisions about me, and I try to live, develop, and behave in accordance with my long-term dreams in all areas – not just when I want to sell myself.

We learned to respect objects. Until then, we were able to accept the one-way, open production-purchase-use-waste process, but from now on, with each created and purchased object, we began to ask ourselves where it would end up? We saw not only the packaging, but also tomorrow's trash to be thrown away in today's shiny device. We asked the question, could it be better? And it could be, because we already had the knowledge to create efficient, long-lasting, repairable objects - only this intention was incomprehensible within the laws of the almighty market economy.

We have learned to respect distances. It is true that we are able to travel vast distances – but why do we do it only because we do not feel comfortable at home? It is true that we are able to bring things from the other side of the world that we could make ourselves – but only because our fellow human beings living in unacceptable conditions “over there” and consequently “cheap” do the slave labor? Today we still travel freely, but only to places where we have long-term business, where we intend to stay and integrate, “be at home”.

We learned to respect and accept ourselves – the real person, not the image we wanted to present. At the time, this seemed like the most distant goal, but those who do not know and appreciate themselves cannot appreciate anyone or anything else. Back then, we did not take seriously that our thinking is not like a computer, but a living organ, the product of the functioning of a neural network, which has a catastrophic effect if it is infected with a stupid, meaningless fairy tale world every day, if it does not receive followable life patterns and a vision of the future. Today, we know that information that cannot be processed at the current level of thinking is poison that can destroy anyone, even turn them into a destructive parasite.

How do we live today? Well, we don't overcomplicate things like our ancestors did, but we pay close attention to the basic rules.

Our children begin to learn about the world in the community of loving, caring families. The first In the years since, everyone has learned to speak their own native language at a high level. They become acquainted with the wildlife, history, and local characteristics of their home. They learn crafts, songs, dances, and games from members of the community, get to know animals, run, swim, or ski – depending on where they were born.

When he is sufficiently attached to his own community and has acquired a local self-awareness based on positive examples, he begins to become acquainted with the civilizational heritage. This is introduced by learning a common language, which is simpler and more focused than the mother tongue, and its strictly logical system allows clear statements to be formulated. In it, he begins to master the principles of thinking, learns the basic knowledge that is essential for understanding everyday phenomena and using tools. It starts at a different age for everyone, and the order of learning adapts to abilities. Most children, however, acquire knowledge at about the same age and speed, and social relationships and togetherness are more important for them at this time. We deal separately with children with development that differs from the average, since the search for talents and their individual development are just as important as the preparation of those who are closer to the average.

The majority will become the Sustainers, the broadest stratum of our civilization, on whose shoulders everything rests. The organized, high-level work of this group "extracts" the surplus of time and resources that the higher levels of the pyramid use. Their experience and expertise also represent enormous value, and their processing leads to new organizational and production methods that will make the satisfaction of our basic needs even more reliable in the long run. We have a difficult task, the population wave has only now been brought under control, and the consequences of climate change also force us to fight. However, thanks to the hard work of the Sustainers, we are holding the front line, and we trust that the continuation will become easier over time. Thanks to the network, they also know exactly how important all this is, and they are proud that they contribute to the survival of man on this planet with their everyday, sometimes trying work.

There are those whose abilities and interests take them further, who are more eager to acquire new knowledge. They will be the Guardians: teachers, artists, doctors, managers of agriculture, who will acquire deeper knowledge in a specialized field, thereby being able to participate in the education of young people, in the preservation or restoration of the health of their peers, in the organization of community activities. Their role is to maintain the order of civilization, to apply the rules and knowledge acquired so far, to collect and systematize experience.

An even narrower circle is formed by the group of Servants, the majority of whom are Helpers, and the rest are Organizers – commonly known as the Hands and the Head. Their selection also begins early. The basic condition for becoming a Servant is selflessness, they are the children who are always happy to help others, even taking risks for the sake of others. This will be an expectation for the members of the Service throughout their lives, so the screening is tough, and each participant is aware that whether they become a candidate for the Service or not, they have a good chance of being in a more suitable place for them.

Both groups receive very high levels of mathematical and communication training, as well as scientific and engineering training appropriate to their areas of interest. In addition, the Hand group receives strong physical and practical technological training, while the Head members are given tasks that require ruthless self-discipline and thinking. It is vital that all those who do not belong there are able to leave this career in time and find their place as Guardians or Sustainers.

Those who stay will be on the front lines. They are the ones who will fight the evil that is lurking around us. with dangers: the Head's task is to organize and implement immediate intervention in case of any problem by selecting and directing the Hands - whether it is an accident or the elimination of long-term pollution. Yes, today Fukushima and the management of radioactive waste left behind are still the biggest tasks, but the damage caused by the unbridled weather and the resuscitation of areas that have become almost uninhabitable are also causing many problems.

We also have heroes, but they are not fairy-tale heroes played by "world stars", power-hungry scoundrels, or "racers" treated like animals. No, they are the Sustainers who have dedicated most of their lives to being good stewards of an area and passing it on to good hands as an inheritance. The Guardians who have ensured the well-being and happiness of the members of a community. The Hands who have risked their physical integrity and lives, or even sacrificed them, to get us out of trouble; and the Heads who have been able to lead them, help them, and sometimes lose them, to the best of their ability.

We have been given many tasks by our predecessors, but for now it seems that we are masters of the situation. We have made serious sacrifices, and we will continue to do so in the future, but we trust that we will pass on a better legacy to our descendants, who will then be able to choose new dreams and goals for themselves more freely. We trust that, following in our footsteps, they will also be happy to take on the responsibility, sacrifices and happiness of becoming an adult again.

You ask, when does all this start?

Maybe right now, in a small hotel room in Frankfurt, while writing these lines, in me. For a long time, the idea that the main problem of our world is the lack of vision for the future has been preoccupying me, so I decided that if no one else is willing to do it, I would create a legend in which there are no fairy-tale spaceships, UFO ants, global annihilation, evils to be defeated and immortal good kids, ... Only a sense of responsibility worthy of an adult, a trust in man that can be proven by historical experiences and scientific experiments.

But if you ask how long you have to wait for the turn, the answer is: forever.

If you choose to wait, only your nightmares will come true, and all this will remain a fairy tale. However, if you are willing to take what is written here seriously, if you carry the questions of this myth with you, if they stick to your thinking like thistles – then the turning point in you has begun now.